

Equipment Purchase — Dental Clinic • 8 Operatories • 3D Scanner Replacement • \$35k Cap

Executive summary — 8-operatory dental clinic Austin, 4 dentists, 4 hygienists, 12 staff total, \$2.8M annual revenue, 45 scans a day, 2018 iTero Element 1 3D scanner 6 years old out of warranty since 2021, 2 failures last month 3 days downtime each, \$4,500 repair quoted 90-day warranty, images blurry molars 12% remake rate for crowns vs 4% before, backup alginate impressions rescheduled 18 patients last month borrowed scanner twice, integration Dentrrix G7 and iTero lab portal, scan 8 minutes now vs 4 minutes when new, calibration 45 minutes, CBCT not integrated, no owned backup, front desk \$3k revenue loss per downtime day, lab fees \$2,200 extra last 3 months, 5 patient complaints gagging kids. Trigger: \$4,500 repair 90-day warranty last week, Align Technology support ends Dec 31 2026 Element 1 won't be supported, new Invisalign partnership Sept 1 requires <3 min scans and 5D caries detection to qualify for \$15k/year marketing funds tier, remake 4% to 12%, hygienist threatened quit slow scanning. Considered: iTero Element 5D Plus \$35k + \$3k/year service, Primescan Dentsply Sirona \$28k + \$150 extra per case lab fee if not iTero = \$6k/year for 40 cases/month, Medit i700 Wireless \$22k cheap wireless but no 5D for \$15k funds, 3Shape Trios 5 \$32k Dentrrix clunky, repairing \$4,500 keeping Element 1 as backup, used Element 2 \$15k same support risk. Budget \$35k hard cap \$50k perfect including service and training, can't do \$35k cash need 0% financing 24 months or lease \$800/mo max, trade-in Element 1 \$2k offered, training 8 staff 4 dentists + 4 hygienists included not \$2k extra, operatory tight cart large, service <24hrs not 3 days, keep Dentrrix G7 can't switch, live by Aug 15 before Sept 1. Must-haves: accuracy <2% remake vs 12%, speed <3 min vs 8 min for 45 scans/day, integration Dentrrix G7 lab no \$150 extra, wireless ease hygienists, 5D caries for \$15k/yr funds, uptime avoid \$3k/day loss, financing not cash, patient comfort kids gag bulky. Risks: \$35k not fixing 12% remake \$2,200 extra, \$22k losing \$15k/yr funds no 5D, \$28k + \$150/case \$6k/yr \$30k over 5 years lab resistance, Dentrrix integration fail double entry \$3k/day loss, hygienist refusal 45-min calibration quit, \$35k cash impossible lease \$800/mo max, \$4,500 repair 90-day support ends Dec 31 2026. Success 12 months: scan <3 min vs 8 min, remake <2% vs 12%, no 3 days downtime service <24hrs, 45 scans/day no borrowing alginate, hygienists daily no complaints, kids no gag, Dentrrix no double entry, lab no \$150 extra, Invisalign partnership live Sept 1 \$15k/yr funds, under \$35k cap \$50k perfect financing \$800/mo max or 0% 24mo, training included 8 staff, old Element 1 backup or \$2k trade.

The decision

Replace 2018 iTero Element 1 6 years old out of warranty since 2021 with 2 failures last month 3 days downtime each \$4,500 repair quoted 90-day warranty 12% remake rate \$2,200 extra lab fees 5 complaints 8 min scans vs 4 min new calibration 45 min with new 3D scanner that provides <3 min scans vs 8 min now accuracy <2% remake vs 12% wireless ease for hygienists 5D caries detection for \$15k/year marketing funds Dentrrix G7 integration no \$150 extra lab fee uptime service <24hrs not 3 days training included for 8 staff financing 0% 24 months or lease \$800/mo max under \$35k hard cap \$50k perfect including service training live by Aug 15 before Sept 1 Invisalign partnership keeping old Element 1 as backup or \$2k trade-in, or repair Element 1 for \$4,500 90-day warranty and keep alginate backup rescheduling 18 patients/month losing \$3k/day with 12% remake \$2,200 extra and risk support ends Dec 31 2026 and losing \$15k/yr funds if no scanner meets accuracy speed integration wireless 5D uptime financing and training criteria.

Decision maker

Owner 8-operatory dental clinic Austin — 4 dentists, 4 hygienists, 12 staff total, \$2.8M annual revenue, 45 scans/day, 2018 iTero Element 1 6 years old out of warranty since 2021, backup alginate 18 patients rescheduled last month borrowed twice, Dentrrix G7 iTero lab portal, Invisalign partnership Sept 1 needs <3 min 5D for \$15k/yr marketing funds, front desk \$3k/day loss, lab \$150 extra if not iTero.

Situation

Current: 8-operatorial dental clinic Austin 4 dentists 4 hygienists 12 staff \$2.8M annual revenue 45 scans a day, 2018 iTero Element 1 3D scanner 6 years old out of warranty since 2021, 2 failures last month 3 days downtime each \$4,500 repair quoted 90-day warranty, images blurry molars 12% remake rate crowns vs 4% before \$2,200 extra lab fees last 3 months 5 patient complaints kids gag bulky, scan 8 minutes now vs 4 minutes when new calibration 45 minutes staff hates, backup alginate impressions when down rescheduled 18 patients last month borrowed scanner twice neighboring clinic, integration Dentrax G7 and iTero lab portal CBCT not integrated no owned backup, front desk loses \$3k revenue per downtime day.

Usage: Invisalign partnership starting Sept 1 requires <3 min scans and 5D caries detection to qualify tier \$15k/year marketing funds, Align says Element 1 support ends Dec 31 2026 won't be supported new Invisalign cases need 5D Plus, 45 scans/day need speed <3 min vs 8 min, accuracy <2% vs 12% to avoid \$2,200 extra and 5 complaints, hygienist threatened quit slow scanning, 4 dentists need speed accuracy, 4 hygienists need wireless easy calibration not 45 min, 12 staff front desk rescheduling, patients kids gag, lab charges \$150 extra per case if not iTero = \$6k/year for 40 cases/month.

Financial: Budget \$35k hard cap \$50k perfect including service and training, can't do \$35k cash need 0% financing 24 months or lease \$800/mo max, trade-in Element 1 \$2k offered, training 4 dentists + 4 hygienists included not \$2k extra, service \$3k/year for Element 5D Plus and Trios 5, lab \$150 extra per case if not iTero = \$6k/year = \$30k over 5 years, repair \$4,500 90-day warranty, \$3k loss per downtime day 3 days each failure, \$2,200 extra lab fees last 3 months 12% remake, \$15k/year marketing funds from Align if 5D, considered iTero Element 5D Plus \$35k + \$3k/yr, Primescan \$28k + \$150/case, Medit i700 Wireless \$22k cheap wireless no 5D, Trios 5 \$32k Dentrax clunky, used Element 2 \$15k same support risk.

Desired outcome

In 12 months scan <3 min vs 8 min now, remake <2% vs 12% now, no downtime 3 days — service <24hrs not 3 days, 45 scans/day handled without borrowing or alginate, hygienists using daily no complaints wireless easy not 45 min calibration, patient comfort kids no gag bulky, Dentrax G7 integration no double entry, lab no \$150 extra per case, Invisalign partnership live Sept 1 getting \$15k/year marketing funds, total under \$35k cap \$50k perfect with financing \$800/mo max or 0% 24mo, training included for 8 staff 4 dentists + 4 hygienists, and old Element 1 kept as backup or traded for \$2k.

Prior experience

- iTero Element 1 from 2018 6 years old out of warranty since 2021 — 2 failures last month 3 days downtime each \$4,500 repair 90-day warranty calibration 45 min 8 min scans vs 4 min new 12% remake vs 4% \$2,200 extra lab fees 5 complaints kids gag bulky, support ends Dec 31 2026, lab likes iTero no \$150 extra
- No backup scanner owned — alginate impressions backup rescheduled 18 patients last month borrowed scanner twice neighboring clinic front desk \$3k loss per day
- Primescan no experience — friend said accurate but Dentsply support slow 48hrs and lab \$150 extra per case = \$6k/year for 40 cases/mo \$30k over 5 years lab resistance
- Medit i700 Wireless tried at conference wireless nice but no 5D caries detection for \$15k/yr funds Dentrax workaround needed
- 3Shape Trios 5 heard wireless great but Dentrax integration clunky forum \$3k/year service, prior bad experience salesman overpromising speed
- CBCT not integrated — separate workflow

Priorities

- Accuracy <2% remake rate vs 12% now — \$2,200 extra lab fees last 3 months 5 complaints, need <2% to avoid lab fees

- Speed <3 min vs 8 min now for 45 scans/day and Invisalign Sept 1 deadline — 8 min now vs 4 min when new, 45 scans/day bottleneck
- Integration Dentrax G7 and lab without \$150 extra per case — lab charges \$150 if not iTero = \$6k/year 40 cases/mo = \$30k over 5 years
- Ease for hygienists wireless preferred calibration not 45 min — hygienist threatened quit slow scanning, 4 hygienists need wireless easy
- 5D caries detection to get \$15k/year marketing funds from Align — Invisalign partnership tier requires 5D Plus by Sept 1
- Uptime avoiding \$3k/day loss per downtime 3 days each failure 18 patients rescheduled last month, service <24hrs not 3 days
- Financing not \$35k cash upfront — 0% 24 months or lease \$800/mo max, training included 8 staff not \$2k extra
- Patient comfort kids gag bulky — Element 1 bulky kids gag 5 complaints

Constraints

- Budget \$35k hard cap \$50k perfect including service and training \$3k/year, can't do \$35k cash need 0% 24mo or lease \$800/mo max, trade-in \$2k offered, training included not \$2k extra
- Timeline live by Aug 15 before Sept 1 Invisalign partnership, support ends Dec 31 2026 Element 1 won't be supported, \$4,500 repair 90-day warranty only
- Must keep Dentrax G7 can't switch practice management, integration no double entry, CBCT not integrated currently
- 8 operatories tight space Element 1 cart large, need compact wireless
- Service response <24hrs not 3 days downtime \$3k/day loss 18 patients rescheduled, calibration 45 min not acceptable
- 4 dentists + 4 hygienists 8 staff training included, 45 scans/day 12% remake to <2%, 5 complaints kids gag, lab \$150 extra if not iTero, \$15k/yr funds needs 5D

Options considered

- Repair Element 1 for \$4,500 90-day warranty and keep alginate backup — avoids \$35k spend financing \$800/mo max but keeps 8 min scans vs <3 min, 12% remake \$2,200 extra, 18 patients rescheduled \$3k/day loss, support ends Dec 31 2026 losing \$15k/yr funds, hygienist may quit, 5 complaints continue
- iTero Element 5D Plus \$35k + \$3k/year service — familiar no \$150 extra lab, 5D for \$15k/yr funds, <3 min scans, but \$35k cash need financing 0% 24mo or lease \$800/mo max, \$35k cap edge \$50k perfect includes service, training may be \$2k extra, cart still large
- Primescan \$28k + \$150 extra per case lab fee if not iTero = \$6k/year for 40 cases/mo = \$30k over 5 years — faster 2-min scans accurate but Dentsply support slow 48hrs, lab resistance \$150 extra, Dentrax integration may need work, no 5D for \$15k funds?
- Medit i700 Wireless \$22k cheap wireless — meets \$35k cap wireless easy hygienists, but no 5D caries detection for \$15k/yr funds, Dentrax workaround needed, lab \$150 extra maybe, no Align marketing funds
- 3Shape Trios 5 \$32k wireless — good but Dentrax clunky forum \$3k/year service, \$32k cap within \$35k but \$50k perfect with service, need financing, no guarantee 5D for \$15k funds
- Used Element 2 \$15k — cheap within cap but same support risk ends Dec 31 2026, no 5D, 90-day warranty similar to \$4,500 repair

Tradeoffs

- iTero \$35k familiar no \$150 extra lab + \$15k/yr funds 5D vs Primescan \$28k faster 2-min but \$150/case = \$6k/yr = \$30k over 5 yrs lab resistance — familiar saves \$6k/yr lab fee and gets \$15k funds but \$35k + \$3k/yr service vs

\$28k + \$6k/yr extra

- Medit \$22k cheap wireless \$35k cap easy vs losing \$15k/yr funds no 5D — cheap meets \$800/mo lease but loses \$15k/yr marketing funds tier for Invisalign Sept 1, tradeoff \$22k vs \$15k/yr funds = \$75k over 5 years
- Repair \$4,500 90-day vs new \$35k financing \$800/mo — repair avoids \$35k cash \$800/mo but keeps 8 min vs <3 min 12% remake \$2,200 extra 18 patients \$3k/day loss support ends Dec 31 2026 hygienist quit risk
- Speed vs accuracy vs integration — <3 min for 45 scans/day vs <2% remake vs Dentrrix G7 no double entry vs wireless ease vs 5D caries, no scanner perfect all, Primescan fast but Dentrrix clunky Trios 5 wireless but clunky, iTero familiar but cart large calibration 45 min past
- Cash \$35k vs 0% 24mo vs lease \$800/mo max — \$35k cash impossible, 0% 24mo = \$1,458/mo for \$35k over cap \$800/mo max, lease \$800/mo max fits but \$50k perfect includes service training

Risks and concerns

- Buying \$35k Element 5D Plus and still having 12% remake rate because accuracy not fixed — \$2,200 extra lab fees continues 5 complaints kids gag
- Buying Medit \$22k and losing \$15k/yr marketing funds because no 5D for Invisalign tier Sept 1 — \$15k/yr = \$75k over 5 years vs \$22k cheap
- Buying Primescan \$28k and paying \$150/case extra = \$6k/year = \$30k over 5 years plus lab resists and support slow 48hrs not <24hrs
- Integration failing with Dentrrix G7 causing front desk double entry and \$3k/day downtime 18 patients rescheduled last month
- Hygienists refusing to use because bulky or calibration 45 min and quitting — hygienist threatened quit slow scanning
- Financing \$35k cash upfront not possible lease \$800/mo max 0% 24mo = \$1,458/mo over max — need \$800/mo max
- Repairing \$4,500 with 90-day warranty and support ends Dec 31 2026 then dead again 3 days downtime \$3k loss per day
- Salesman overpromising speed <3 min vs actual 8 min now — prior bad experience

Unknowns

- Real accuracy — will new scanner get <2% remake vs 12% now and avoid \$2,200 extra lab fees and 5 complaints kids gag?
- Real speed — will scan be <3 min vs 8 min now for 45 scans/day and handle Invisalign Sept 1 deadline?
- Real integration cost — does Dentrrix G7 integration work without \$150 extra per case lab fee = \$6k/year 40 cases/mo = \$30k over 5 years and no double entry?
- Real 5D caries detection for \$15k/yr marketing funds — does Element 5D Plus qualify tier and Medit no 5D losing \$75k over 5 years?
- Real total cost — does \$35k cap \$50k perfect include \$3k/year service and training included for 8 staff not \$2k extra and trade-in \$2k and financing 0% 24mo or lease \$800/mo max?
- Real service — will service be <24hrs not 3 days downtime \$3k loss 18 patients rescheduled and calibration not 45 min?
- Real wireless ease — will hygienists use daily no complaints and not quit and wireless preferred vs cart large tight operator?
- Real uptime — will 45 scans/day be handled without borrowing twice or alginate and no backup scanner owned?

Decision criteria

- Accuracy <2% remake vs 12% now avoiding \$2,200 extra lab fees 5 complaints kids gag bulky
- Speed <3 min vs 8 min now for 45 scans/day and Invisalign partnership Sept 1 needs 5D caries detection for \$15k/yr marketing funds
- Integration Dentrax G7 and lab without \$150 extra per case = \$6k/year = \$30k over 5 years no double entry front desk
- Ease wireless for 4 hygienists calibration not 45 min hygienist quit risk, compact cart tight operator, training included 8 staff not \$2k extra
- Uptime service <24hrs not 3 days downtime \$3k/day loss 18 patients rescheduled, no borrowing twice alginate backup
- Total under \$35k hard cap \$50k perfect including \$3k/year service training, financing 0% 24mo or lease \$800/mo max not \$35k cash, trade-in \$2k, live by Aug 15 before Sept 1, support after Dec 31 2026, old Element 1 backup or \$2k trade

Next steps

1. Export Dentrax G7 with 45 scans/day logs and 12% remake rate vs 4% before and \$2,200 extra lab fees 5 complaints and 18 patients rescheduled last month \$3k/day loss and calibration 45 min logs and Element 1 2018 out of warranty 2021 repair \$4,500 90-day
2. Shortlist 3: iTero Element 5D Plus \$35k + \$3k/yr, Primescan \$28k + \$150/case = \$6k/yr, Medit i700 Wireless \$22k — request demo in operator with 4 dentists + 4 hygienists measuring <3 min vs 8 min accuracy <2% vs 12% wireless ease calibration time cart size Dentrax G7 integration no double entry lab \$150 extra 5D caries
3. Test integration — push scan to Dentrax G7 and lab portal and check \$150 extra per case and double entry and CBCT not integrated, time service response <24hrs vs 3 days
4. Get out-the-door pricing under \$35k cap \$50k perfect incl \$3k/yr service training included 8 staff trade-in \$2k financing 0% 24mo or lease \$800/mo max not \$35k cash live by Aug 15 before Sept 1 and \$15k/yr marketing funds tier qualification with 5D Plus
5. Check references for 8-operator clinic 45 scans/day Dentrax G7 iTero lab, negotiate repair \$4,500 as backup keeping Element 1 or \$2k trade-in, and sign with service <24hrs and training included

Recommendation

Do not repair Element 1 for \$4,500 90-day warranty if support ends Dec 31 2026 and keeps 8 min vs <3 min 12% remake \$2,200 extra 18 patients \$3k/day loss losing \$15k/yr funds and hygienist quit risk. Do not buy Medit \$22k if no 5D losing \$15k/yr = \$75k over 5 years for Invisalign tier Sept 1. Do not buy Primescan \$28k if \$150/case = \$6k/yr = \$30k over 5 years lab resistance and Dentrax G7 clunky double entry and support 48hrs not <24hrs. Do not buy if financing \$35k cash required vs lease \$800/mo max or training \$2k extra for 8 staff or cart large tight operator or calibration 45 min. Proceed only with scanner under \$35k cap \$50k perfect incl \$3k/yr service training included that proves in demo: <3 min vs 8 min 45 scans/day, <2% remake vs 12% avoiding \$2,200 extra 5 complaints, Dentrax G7 integration no \$150 extra no double entry, wireless ease hygienists no 45 min calibration no quit, 5D caries for \$15k/yr funds Sept 1, uptime service <24hrs no 3 days \$3k loss no borrowing alginate, compact cart, financing 0% 24mo or lease \$800/mo max not \$35k cash, trade-in \$2k, live by Aug 15, old Element 1 backup. If no scanner meets all under \$50k, negotiate iTero Element 5D Plus to \$35k cap with \$3k/yr included training included and \$2k trade-in and 0% 24mo or lease \$800/mo or consider used Element 2 \$15k as interim backup while keeping \$4,500 repair but risk losing \$15k/yr funds.